

CREATIVE ECONOMY AS A STRATEGIC LEVER FOR RESILIENT SUSTAINABLE REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT: INTEGRATING INNOVATION, ECOLOGY, AND ENTREPRENEURIAL ECOSYSTEMS

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Abstract

The study examines transformation processes in regional business ecosystems (RBEs) under the influence of creative industries development. The main barriers limiting the growth of the creative economy at the regional level are identified, including the lack of institutional and resource support, weak integration of digital technologies and limited financing opportunities. A system for assessing the competitiveness of RBEs is proposed, including four key criteria: creative industries development, innovative and digital potential, socio-economic effects, ecosystem dynamics and business environment. The key effects of creative industries development are identified, such as strengthening network interactions, diversification of entrepreneurial activity, growth of intellectual capital capitalization, increasing the competitiveness of the region and optimizing government participation. The study examines transformation processes in regional entrepreneurial ecosystems (REEs) under the influence of creative industries development. The main barriers limiting the growth of the creative economy at the regional level are identified, including a lack of institutional and resource support, weak integration of digital technologies and limited financing opportunities. The study developed a system for assessing the competitiveness of the RPES, including four key criteria: development of creative industries, innovative and digital potential, socio-economic effects, ecosystem dynamics and business environment. Measurable indicators were proposed for each criterion, including the share of creative industries in GRP, the level of digitalization of enterprises, the number of jobs in the creative sector, the number of accelerators and incubators for startups. Based on the analysis of empirical data, the key effects of creative industries development are identified: strengthening of network interactions, which is manifested in the increase in the number of collaborations between companies and educational organizations; diversification of entrepreneurial activity due to the involvement of the self-employed and young people; growth of capitalization of intellectual capital, expressed in the increase in the number of patents and copyrights; increasing the competitiveness of the region through the development of local brands and attracting investors; as well as optimization of state participation in the development of the creative economy by improving the mechanisms of financial and educational support.

Keywords: creative economy, regional entrepreneurial ecosystem, competitiveness, creative industries, digitalization, intellectual capital, government support, innovation strategies, socio-economic effects, ecosystem dynamics.

I. Introduction

Modern economic realities necessitate the search for new growth drivers and mechanisms for increasing the competitiveness of regions. One of these factors is the creative economy, which includes industries based on knowledge, innovation, digital technologies and cultural potential. Unlike traditional industrial and resource-based approaches to economic management, the creative economy forms new entrepreneurial business models based on collaboration, flexibility, digitalization and ecosystem interaction. In this regard, the study of its impact on regional entrepreneurial ecosystems (REE) is of particular importance, since their transformation is becoming critical to ensuring sustainable and effective development of the modern Russian regional economy.

Relevance of the study

In the context of structural changes and the overall transformation of the economy, caused by global political challenges of our time, technological shifts, digitalization and changing consumption patterns, traditional mechanisms of entrepreneurial activity are losing their effectiveness. The development of creative industries and an ecosystem approach to managing the regional economy create new competitive advantages due to:

- diversification of the region's economic structure and increasing the share of intellectual capital;
- creating innovative business models focused on digital platforms, collaborative consumption and intangible assets;
- strengthening ecosystem links between small, medium and large businesses, educational institutions and government institutions;
- formation of sustainable territorial brands that attract investment and human capital.

However, despite the growing importance of the creative economy, the issue of mechanisms for its integration into regional entrepreneurial ecosystems remains understudied. It is necessary to determine which factors contribute to the development of such ecosystems and which barriers limit their potential.

The modern economy is undergoing a global transition from a resource-industrial model to a model of knowledge, innovation and digital solutions. In this regard, traditional competitive strategies of regions are undergoing the following significant changes:

- production capacity is giving way to intangible assets such as intellectual property, technology, branding and creative content;
- the role of human capital and interdisciplinary competencies is growing, which requires the modernization of the education and training system;
- New ecosystem business models are being formed, based on cooperation between various market participants, rather than on fierce competition.

These factors indicate the need to revise approaches to the development of the RPES, adapt them to new economic realities and introduce tools that promote the growth of regional competitiveness.

Purpose of the study

The aim of this study is to analyze new business models emerging in the context of the creative economy and the ecosystem effects that may result from these processes.

The study aims to solve the following tasks:

- to conduct a theoretical analysis of the concept of creative economy and its impact on the competitiveness of regional entrepreneurial ecosystems (REE);
- develop criteria for assessing the competitiveness of the RPES, taking into account the specifics of the creative industries;

- to identify existing problems in measuring the competitiveness of the regional economic zone, associated with the inadequacy of the analytical and statistical base at the regional level;
- propose new business models for the development of the RPES based on the principles of the creative economy;
- assess the potential ecosystem effects from the implementation of the proposed business models.

The main hypotheses of the article

1. The high level of development of creative industries contributes to increasing the competitiveness of regional entrepreneurial ecosystems.
2. In Russia, there is no unified system of statistical accounting of data necessary for a comprehensive assessment of the competitiveness of the RPES in the context of the creative economy.
3. The development of new business models focused on ecosystem interaction will allow regions to strengthen their competitive advantages.
4. The implementation of the proposed business models will lead to the formation of multiplier ecosystem effects, including increased employment, development of innovative entrepreneurship and increased investment attractiveness of regions.

II. Methods

In the course of studying the creative economy as a driver of competitiveness within regional entrepreneurial ecosystems (REEs), a comprehensive and multi-methodological approach was employed, integrating theoretical inquiry with empirical analysis. The research framework is grounded in an interdisciplinary paradigm that synthesizes principles from economic theory, entrepreneurship studies, regional economics, digital transformation, and the political economy of creative industries.

A systems-theoretical perspective was applied to conceptualize regional entrepreneurial ecosystems as complex, adaptive socio-economic systems characterized by dynamic interactions among diverse stakeholders—including entrepreneurs, institutions, support organizations, and public agencies. This approach facilitated the examination of emergent properties, feedback loops, and non-linear development trajectories inherent in REEs.

Complementing this, the ecosystem lens was utilized to analyze networked collaboration, knowledge spillovers, and the evolution of innovative business models oriented toward open innovation, platformization, and cross-sectoral integration—key features of contemporary creative economies.

The methodological toolkit encompasses several complementary techniques:

Analysis and synthesis were employed to operationalize the concept of the creative economy and assess its transformative impact on regional entrepreneurial dynamics;

Content analysis was conducted on a corpus of strategic documents, including regional development programs, national policy frameworks, academic publications, and institutional reports (from HSE, Rosstat, and other research bodies), enabling a qualitative assessment of institutional support mechanisms and policy coherence;

Statistical and econometric methods were applied to analyze data from official sources, including the Federal State Statistics Service (Rosstat), the Russian Index of Regional Competitiveness and Innovation (RRIKI), as well as indicators related to migration, labor markets, digital infrastructure, and sectoral output in creative industries.

Special attention was given to leveraging data from the Unified Interagency Information and Statistical System (EMISS)—a centralized state information resource providing open, non-discriminatory access to official statistical databases formed under the federal statistical program (as per Fedstat.ru). This allowed for robust cross-regional comparisons and trend identification.

The integration of these methods enabled the identification of key developmental trends in the creative economy across Russian regions, critical bottlenecks in measuring REE competitiveness, the design of novel, sustainability-oriented business models, and an evidence-based assessment of their potential macroeconomic and structural impacts. This holistic methodology ensures both theoretical rigor and practical relevance for policymakers aiming to harness creativity as a lever for resilient and inclusive regional development.

III. Results

The creative economy, based on cultural and creative industries, is becoming an important driver of socio-economic progress, influencing various aspects of entrepreneurial activity. The impact of the creative economy on entrepreneurial ecosystems is that creative industries contribute to increasing the investment and tourism potential of regions, improving the quality of life of the population, creating new jobs and improving territories. In addition, they stimulate the development of related sectors of the economy, such as catering, trade, sports and logistics [1].

In Russia, the contribution of creative industries to GDP has demonstrated steady growth: from 2.8% in 2017–2018 to 3.5% in 2023; with government support, the share of the creative economy is expected to reach 6% by 2030 [2].

Creative industries in Russia are demonstrating steady growth, increasing their contribution to the gross domestic product (GDP); Figure 1 shows the dynamics of their share in GDP over the past five years [3]:

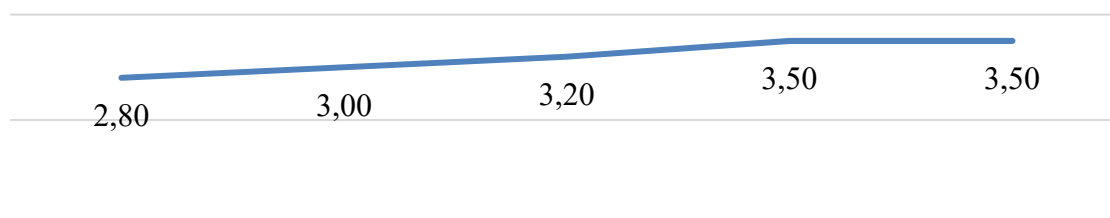


Figure 1. Share of creative industries in GDP, %

The contribution of creative industries to the economy varies significantly across Russian regions (Table 1).

Table 1. Share of creative industries in the gross regional product (GRP) of some subjects of the Russian Federation, %

Region	Share of creative industries in GRP	Note
Moscow	6.0	High concentration of creative industries.
Saint Petersburg	5.8	Developed cultural and creative environment.
Novosibirsk region	4.5	Active development of the IT sector and other creative areas.
Tomsk region	4.2	Significant contribution from educational and scientific institutions.
Krasnoyarsk region	3.0	Recognized as the most creative region in 2024 [5].

Sverdlovsk region	3.0	Entered the top 5 creative regions in 2024 [6].
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In 2023, the Agency for Strategic Initiatives (ASI) reported that the contribution of creative industries to Russia's GDP was 3%. The goal is to increase this figure to 6% by 2030 [3]. It is worth noting that in 2024, Krasnoyarsk Krai was recognized as the most creative region in Russia. The industry employs 20 thousand people, there are 13 thousand creative industry entities, and the contribution of creative industries to the GRP is 3%.

Thus, creative industries continue to develop, exerting an ever-increasing influence on the economy of the country and its regions.

As for the regional aspects of transformation, we note that the influence of the creative economy on the regions of Russia is uneven. In some regions, such as St. Petersburg, Tyumen, Novosibirsk and Kaliningrad regions, creative industries create a product with high added value. However, in 49 regions their contribution to the internal regional product remains low, which indicates the need to develop this sector [4].

Unfortunately, there is no data in the available sources on the contribution of Russian regions to creative industries on a national scale. However, there are ratings that evaluate the development of creative industries in the subjects of the Russian Federation. One of these ratings is the Russian Regional Index of Creative Industries (RRICI), prepared by the Institute for Statistical Studies and Economics of Knowledge of the National Research University Higher School of Economics. According to the latest edition of RRICI, regions are divided into four groups depending on the level of development of creative industries [7]:

- Leaders: 21 regions, including Moscow, St. Petersburg and Novosibirsk Oblast.
- Evolutionary: 19 regions.
- Effective: 15 regions.
- Catch-up: 30 regions.

Leading regions demonstrate high indicators in the development of creative industries, which is reflected in their economies and infrastructure supporting the sector.

Table 2. Distribution of regions into groups depending on the level of development of creative industries

Group	Regions
Leaders	Moscow, Saint Petersburg, Novosibirsk region, Tomsk region, Republic of Tatarstan, Ivanovo region, Belgorod region, Nizhny Novgorod region, Kostroma region, Sverdlovsk region, Ulyanovsk region, Tyumen region, Oryol region, Kaliningrad region, Republic of Sakha (Yakutia), Krasnoyarsk region, Astrakhan region, Novgorod region, Vologda region, Chelyabinsk region, Arkhangelsk region.
Evolutionary	Republic of Mordovia, Republic of North Ossetia – Alania, Penza Region, Ryazan Region, Republic of Karelia, Sevastopol, Lipetsk Region, Yaroslavl Region, Republic of Crimea, Omsk Region, Khanty-Mansi Autonomous Okrug – Yugra, Kirov Region, Volgograd Region, Tula Region, Karachay-Cherkess Republic, Primorsky Krai, Kursk Region, Kamchatka Krai, Vladimir Region.
Effective	Voronezh region, Kaluga region, Smolensk region, Samara region, Saratov region, Chuvash Republic, Mari El Republic, Irkutsk region, Perm region, Khabarovsk region, Moscow region, Krasnodar region, Udmurt Republic, Transbaikalia region, Rostov region.
Catch-up	Republic of Kalmykia, Magadan Region, Komi Republic, Republic of Bashkortostan, Republic of Adygea, Bryansk Region, Murmansk Region, Republic of Buryatia, Yamalo-Nenets Autonomous Okrug, Sakhalin Region, Pskov Region, Tambov Region, Tver Region, Kemerovo Region, Republic of Khakassia, Altai Republic, Nenets Autonomous Okrug, Altai Krai, Stavropol Krai, Chukotka Autonomous Okrug, Republic of Tyva, Orenburg Region, Chechen Republic, Jewish Autonomous Region, Republic of Dagestan, Kurgan Region, Kabardino-Balkarian Republic, Leningrad Region, Republic of Ingushetia, Amur Region.

It should be noted that in 2024, the Khanty-Mansiysk Autonomous Okrug - Yugra rose to 10th place in the ranking, improving its position by 24 lines. In Yugra, the share of creative industries in the gross regional product is more than 100 billion rubles, and the number of subjects is 7,171 units [8].

Thus, although specific data on the contribution of each region to the all-Russian creative industries is limited, ratings such as RRIKI provide an idea of the development of this sector in various regions of the Russian Federation.

The development of creative clusters and ecosystems contributes to the formation of sustainable links between creators, business and the state, which ensures the viability of careers in creative fields and enriches regional economies. The transformation of traditional entrepreneurial ecosystems under the influence of the creative economy is a key factor in increasing the competitiveness and sustainable development of regions. To achieve positive results, it is necessary to systematically develop creative industries, support from the state and business, as well as the active participation of local communities in the formation of creative clusters.

An analysis of the presented data on the regions of Russia, divided into the groups "Leaders", "Evolutionary", "Efficient" and "Catching up", allows us to identify certain patterns in their development, as well as to understand what factors contributed to their classification into one category or another. Based on the data in Table 2, we will highlight the general criteria by which the regions of the Russian Federation are distributed into the corresponding groups (Figures 2-5).

IV. Discussion

I. Subsection One: Institutions as Systemic Enablers of Sustainability Transitions

Thus, the distribution of regions into groups is determined by the development of economic and social infrastructure, the level of urbanization, population migration and the level of involvement in creative industries. Interestingly, a high level of development of creative industries does not always correlate with economic well-being. In some "leader" regions, the level of gross regional product per capita may be lower than the national median. However, this phenomenon is often explained by the high level of employment in creative sectors, which does not always provide high incomes at the formation stage.

In addition, there are consequences of the uneven distribution of resources and opportunities for the development of creative industries across the country. As the analysis showed, regions with the highest level of education and concentration of students, in particular those where leading universities are located, demonstrate more active participation in the creative economy. This is confirmed by the above-mentioned regions, where creative specialties and cultural initiatives are actively supported at the state level.

The conducted analysis underlines the importance of adopting a holistic approach to the development of creative industries in Russia, taking into account the unique characteristics of the regions. Support and development of the creative sector should be based on local resources and potential in order to strengthen entrepreneurial ecosystems and ensure the long-term development of the creative economy in the country. For example, Krasnodar Krai, despite its high economic potential, was included in the penultimate group in terms of the level of development of creative industries. This is due to a number of objective factors:

1. Economic factors:

the predominance of traditional industries (the region's economy is oriented towards agriculture, tourism, construction and logistics, which leaves the creative sector in a secondary position);

low share of GRP of creative industries (despite the overall economic growth, creative industries in the region have not achieved a significant share in the regional domestic product).

2. Social factors:

weak support for creative entrepreneurship (small business development programs are mainly aimed at agriculture, trade and tourism, and the creative industries sector receives insufficient funding);

limited number of specialists (the region does not have enough personnel with competencies in the creative economy, and many talented specialists leave for Moscow, St. Petersburg or abroad).

3. Geographic factors:

high seasonality of the economy (tourism and the agro-industrial complex are highly dependent on seasonal fluctuations, which does not contribute to the sustainable development of the creative sector);

remoteness from the leading centers of the creative economy (despite the developed transport network, Krasnodar Krai is not an innovation hub, like, for example, Moscow or St. Petersburg).

4. Cultural factors

focus on traditional cultural formats (the region has a rich cultural heritage, but modern creative areas, such as digital art, design, game development, music startups, are underdeveloped);

low number of creative spaces (the number of art clusters, co-working spaces, technology hubs and other platforms for developing creative businesses is significantly lower than in leading regions).

5. Demographic factors (let's look at them in more detail).

5.1 Outflow of youth (young creative entrepreneurs and specialists in the field of IT, design, media often prefer to move to the capitals, where there are greater opportunities for growth)

Table 3. Dynamics of the age and sex structure of the population of Krasnodar Krai for 2019 and 2024, people [9]

Age (years)	The entire population			Urban population			Rural population		
	male and female	husband.	female	male and female	husband.	female	male and female	husband.	female
As of January 01, 2019									
All population	62682	32310	30372	31302	16151	15151	31380	16159	15221
25-34	157541	74937	82604	88116	40858	47258	69425	34079	35346
35-44	143936	65804	78132	76181	33948	42233	67755	31856	35899
45-54	142029	59572	82457	75335	30190	45145	66694	29382	37312
55-64	75318	27279	48039	41418	14734	26684	33900	12545	21355
total	62682	32310	30372	31302	16151	15151	31380	16159	15221
As of January 01, 2024									
All population	83463	40340	43123	48253	23279	24974	35210	17061	18149
25-34	59547	18909	40638	32565	10364	22201	26982	8545	18437
35-44	18405	5455	12950	8736	2591	6145	9669	2864	6805
45-54	3324611	1637249	1687362	1924231	938114	986117	1400380	699135	701245
55-64	2183838	1101251	1082587	1301439	650867	650572	882399	450384	432015
total	83463	40340	43123	48253	23279	24974	35210	17061	18149

To analyze the data presented in Table 3 on the age and gender structure of the population of the Krasnodar Territory in 2019 and 2024 from the perspective of the region's ability to develop a creative economy, we highlight a number of aspects:

The dynamics of the number of young people (25-34 years old) as the most creative segment of the population shows that in 2019, the population of the Krasnodar Territory aged 25-34 was 157.54 thousand people, of which just under 75 thousand were men and 82.6 thousand were women. At the same time, the urban population in this age group was 88.12 thousand people, and the rural population - 69.42 thousand people. In 2024, the number of young people in the analyzed age period was 59.54 thousand people, of which 18.91 thousand were men and 40.64 thousand were women. The urban population in this age group is 32.6 thousand people, the rural population - 26.98 thousand people.

Thus, for the period from 2019 to 2024, there is a significant decrease in the number of young people in the Krasnodar Territory. At the same time, in cities there is a more intense decline in the number of young people (from 88.11 thousand to 32.56 thousand people), and in rural areas the decline is less pronounced (from 69.42 thousand to 26.98 thousand people). It is important to take this trend into account when developing a strategy for the development of a creative economy, since it is young people who play a key role in the development of innovative industries.

It is noted that the urban population shows a significantly greater reduction compared to the rural population, which indicates a trend towards urbanization of youth, which reflects the need to develop urban infrastructure and create jobs in cities, as well as to support creative industries in the urban environment. The development of a creative economy in cities can provide greater potential for attracting young people. In the age groups of 35-44 years and older, a less noticeable change in numbers is observed, that is, the reduction mainly affected younger age groups.

Thus, Krasnodar Krai needs to focus on creating conditions for retaining young people in the region, for this purpose it is necessary to develop programs to support start-ups, invest in the creation of creative industry centers, as well as in infrastructure that would attract young people. Another important area is the development of educational programs in the field of creative industries and technologies, support for innovative start-ups, as well as cooperation with universities and research institutions to develop local research and development. In connection with the urbanization of youth, it is necessary to invest in the development of urban infrastructure, including the creation of jobs, improving transport accessibility and developing cultural facilities that can attract young people. The decrease in the number of young people in Krasnodar Krai should be a signal for taking active measures to improve the conditions for the development of the creative economy and stimulate the growth of the number of young specialists.

5.2 Insufficient level of urbanization (large cities of the region, except for Krasnodar, are not developed enough to attract large creative companies and talents). Thus, according to the All-Russian population census, 5.8 million people live in Krasnodar Krai as of January 1, 2025, of which 3.34 million (57.29%) are urban residents and 2.49 million people (42.71%) are rural residents.

Thus, Krasnodar Krai has high potential for developing a creative economy due to its geographical location, tourist attractiveness and educational opportunities. However, the prevalence of traditional industries, insufficient support for creative entrepreneurship and the outflow of talented youth prevent it from becoming a leader. To move into a higher group, it is necessary to develop infrastructure, finance startups in the creative sphere, as well as systematically attract specialists and investors.

As for the regional aspects of development, the following trends in the development of creative industries have been observed in the past five years: according to data released by the Center for Creative Industries Development (CRDI), 4.6 million Russians are currently employed in the creative sector, which is 500 thousand people more than in 2018. At the same time, according to Rosstat, 2.6 million people were employed in the creative industries in 2020, or 3.7% of the total number of people employed in the country. Thus, between 2018 and 2020, the number of employees in the creative sector increased by 23.1% (from 2.6 million to 4.6 million people) [4]. However, data for the period from 2020 to 2023 is not available, which makes it difficult to assess the dynamics of employment in the creative sector in recent years.

As for traditional sectors of the economy, such as agriculture and services, specific data on the percentage growth in employment between 2018 and 2023 is difficult to find. However, overall, agricultural production in Russia increased by 33.2% between 2014 and 2023, indicating an increase in activity in the agricultural sector [10]. According to a study by the ASI Creative Economy Development Center, in 2022, the revenue of the creative sector in Russia increased by 28.6% compared to 2021, which significantly exceeds the average for the country's economy (15.6%) [4]. In Moscow, the total revenue of creative industry companies exceeded 3 trillion rubles in 2018 [11]. For comparison, in 2018, the gross added value (GVA) of agriculture, forestry and fisheries amounted to 2.3% of the total GVA in the Russian economy, and 4.9% in the construction sector. [12].

II. Subsection Two: Multi-Level Coordination as a Governance Imperative for Sustainable Regional Development

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Thus, although the creative sector demonstrates significant growth, its volume remains smaller compared to traditional sectors of the economy. Income growth in the creative sector exceeds the average for the economy, but traditional industries such as agriculture and construction also show

positive dynamics. According to the Agency for Strategic Initiatives, in 2023, the GVA of the creative sector amounted to 5.4 trillion rubles, which corresponds to 3.5% of the total GDP of Russia [4]. The Chairman of the Russian Center for the Circulation of Rights to the Results of Creative Activity (RCIS) noted that an increase in investment in the creative industries to 10% of the total investment could lead to an increase in Russia's GDP by 2 trillion rubles [13]. There has been a significant increase in investment in the tourism sector. In 2023, the volume of investment in the tourism industry exceeded 800 billion rubles, which is 37% more than in the previous year [14]. In agriculture, the investment dynamics were less stable. In the first nine months of 2023, investment in agriculture decreased by 4% compared to the same period of the previous year [15].

Thus, the share of investments directed to creative industries is about 2-3% of the total volume of investments in small and medium businesses, which is in line with the previously mentioned data. At the same time, traditional sectors such as tourism receive significantly more attention from investors and government programs, which is confirmed by the growth of investments in this sector.

According to the Institute for Creative Industries Development at the National Research University Higher School of Economics, there were 420 creative clusters operating in Russia in 2023 [16]. In 2023, the Creative Economy Week, organized by the Foundation for the Development of Creative Economy, Entrepreneurship and Innovation, was held in Pskov, bringing together more than 1,500 participants from 20 regions of Russia and the world [17]. The Agency for Strategic Initiatives (ASI) reports that systemic state support for creative industries will increase their share in the economy from 2.2% to 6% by 2030 [18]. In Krasnoyarsk Krai, the volume of investment in creative industries has grown by 291% in recent years [19]. According to the Center for Strategic Research, the contribution of the creative economy to Russia's GDP in 2022 was about 5%, while in developed countries this figure reaches 8–12% [20]. At the same time, traditional sectors such as agriculture, construction and industry continue to receive a significant share of investment and government support. Thus, statistics show that creative industries are indeed developing, but much more slowly and with a lower level of support from government authorities compared to traditional sectors of the economy. These trends highlight the need for increased attention to creative industries to stimulate their growth and contribution to the regional economy. Despite the positive dynamics in the development of creative industries, their growth remains less intense compared to traditional sectors of the economy.

The creative economy is becoming an integral driver of the transformation of traditional entrepreneurial ecosystems, promoting digitalization, diversification of the economy and the emergence of new business models. However, the pace of development of creative industries varies significantly across regions, which requires targeted support measures, especially in regions with a low share of the creative sector in GRP. The development of creative industries in Russian regions faces a number of significant barriers. These barriers slow down or complicate the process of transforming traditional economies and the full integration of creative areas into regional business ecosystems. Let us consider the main barriers, as well as possible ways to overcome them.

1. Insufficient support from state and local authorities

The problem is that many regions have insufficiently developed measures of state support for creative industries, such as benefits, grants, tax preferences and other incentive tools. In addition, regions often do not have specific programs to support small businesses focused on the creative economy. According to the RRIKI report, only 30% of Russian regions have existing programs to support creative industries, while in developed countries this figure reaches 80-90%. A possible solution is to develop specialized state programs to support creative industries, including subsidies,

grants, tax incentives, the creation of business incubators and technology parks focused on creative startups. In addition, regional authorities should more actively interact with cultural and educational institutions to create platforms and ecosystems that support innovative and creative entrepreneurship.

To create an effective platform and ecosystem that supports innovative and creative entrepreneurship, regional authorities can be offered a model that unites cultural, educational and business structures. Such a model should provide for a comprehensive approach involving various sectors and institutions.

An example of a model that can be applied in the Krasnodar Region is the Integrated Platform "Creative Hub", the goal of which is to create a single ecosystem that unites cultural, educational and business structures to support startups and entrepreneurs in the creative industries. The main components of this system are shown in Figure 6.

Russia has experience in successfully creating creative hubs and corresponding infrastructure projects, the main goal of which is to support creative industries. Such hubs combine cultural, educational and business structures, providing startups and entrepreneurs with platforms for growth and development: Skolkovo Technopark (Moscow), IT Park (Kazan), Rosatom Innohub (Moscow), Tsekh (Saint Petersburg), ZIL Creative Cluster (cultural center) (Moscow), Kazan Fair Creative Cluster (Kazan), etc.

Krasnodar also has creative spaces offering unique opportunities for work, creativity and cultural exchange (locations, coworkings, art spaces, galleries). These spaces are centers for exhibitions, master classes and lectures (table 4).

Some of the Krasnodar creative spaces presented in Table 4 participate in state programs for the improvement and development of the urban environment:

The art space (implements theatrical and choreographic projects, attracting creative people) is in great demand. Thus, in October 2024, the premiere of Evgenia Pichkaleva's performance took place.

The creative business cluster, located on the territory of former workshops, is planned for reconstruction; in particular, the facades and original elements of the building will be restored, which could become an example of an integrated approach to the creation of creative spaces.



Figure 6. Components of the creative ecosystem References

The creative business cluster, located on the territory of former workshops, is planned for reconstruction; in particular, the facades and original elements of the building will be restored, which could become an example of an integrated approach to the creation of creative spaces.

The Krasnodar Park, built by Sergey Galitsky, also serves as a benchmark for the creation of public spaces and still actively participates in the national project “Formation of a Comfortable Urban Environment”.

These spaces not only become places for creative expression, but also actively participate in government initiatives aimed at improving and developing the urban environment.

The examples considered show that Russia has successful experience in creating creative hubs that promote the development of both local and international projects in the field of culture, art, technology and entrepreneurship. It is important to note that the creation of such hubs requires a comprehensive approach, including support for business, cultural and educational initiatives, as

well as the participation of the authorities and investors to form a sustainable and competitive ecosystem.

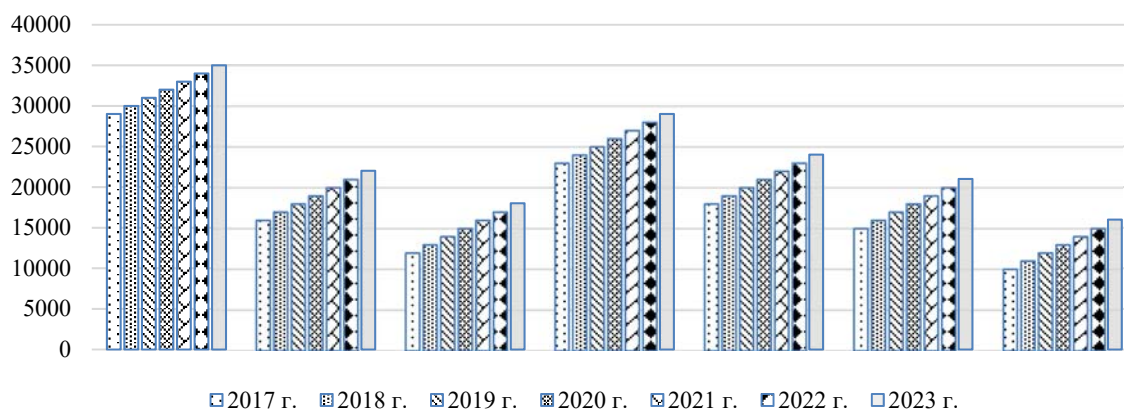
Table 4. List of creative centers in Krasnodar

Name	Type of space	Notes	Address
Creative cluster Kolos	Cluster	Cultural center, office spaces, recreation areas	Kalinina st., 368
Art space Svoi	Art space	Theatre projects, photo shoots, events	Zipovskaya st., 5
Space	Multifunctional	Unique interior for various events	Zipovskaya st., 5
Space Graphite	Art space	Ideal for photo shoots and trainings	Babushkina st., 252
Art Loft Pavilion	Loft	Four spaces for photo sessions and events	Zipovskaya st., 5
Larin Gallery	Gallery	Experimental exhibitions, collaboration with artists	st. Oktyabrskaya, 60/1
Coworking Platform	Coworking	Master classes, conferences	Pushkin/Krasnaya st., 43/6; Severnaya st., 365
Art Center Bronze Horse	Loft	Contemporary art and antiques	Kalinina st., 291
Dorothea Art Gallery	Gallery	Lectures and master classes	st. Sadovaya, 161/2, building 1
Coworking Bloks	Coworking	Smart offices and regular trainings	Krasnaya St., 118
Private Museum Mansion	Museum	Exhibitions of antiques, handicrafts	Frunze st., 37
Harrison Art	Shop/Art space	Master classes, art exhibitions	Krasnoarmeyskaya st., 45, 2nd floor
Gallery ArtSoyuz	Gallery	Exhibitions and master classes with designers and artists	st. Oktyabrskaya, 51

Lack of infrastructure for the development of creative industries as a problem is that in many regions the infrastructure necessary for the full functioning of creative industries is absent or poorly developed: art clusters, coworking spaces, innovation centers and accelerators. Insufficient development of digital infrastructure in some territories limits access to online markets and opportunities for creative companies. Leading regions such as Moscow, St. Petersburg and Novosibirsk already have a developed network of technology parks, creative clusters and accelerators, while in most Russian regions such infrastructure is either absent or is at an early stage of development.

Possible solutions to this problem could be the construction and development of creative clusters and coworking spaces, where young entrepreneurs can not only work, but also exchange experiences, look for partners and investors, as well as support and creation of digital infrastructure for creative industries, including platforms for the sale and promotion of creative products, as well as improved access to Internet resources for businesses operating in the creative sphere.

3. The lack of qualified personnel and high youth migration as one of the most important problems is one of the significant barriers to the growth of the creative economy in the regions. The lack of qualified specialists working in such industries as design, animation, architecture, IT and media is due to the migration of young people to larger cities such as Moscow and St. Petersburg due to the greater number of jobs and higher salaries, which hinders the development of creative industries in small and medium-sized regions (Figure 7).



Figure

7. Migration rates (inflow) of young people (aged 22-35) by federal districts of Russia for 2017-2023, people [12].

A possible solution to the problem of youth migration from the regions could be the development of training and internship programs, as well as the creation of accelerators and incubators for young professionals in the creative industries, which can provide the necessary practical skills. It is also necessary to create attractive conditions for work in the regions, including improving housing conditions, offering subsidies for renting housing and supporting start-ups, which encourages specialists to return to their regions or stay in them.

4. The problem associated with limited investment in creative projects is that investment in creative industries remains quite low relative to the volume of investment in the regional economy. This is due to the uncertainty in assessing the profitability of creative projects and the lack of necessary experience in this area among investors. According to the study "Index of Creative Potential in Russian Cities", the contribution of creative industries to the country's GDP is 4-6%, taking into account the multiplier effect, and in fact - 2.4% [21]. In addition, RBC notes that in 2021, the contribution of creative industries to Russia's GDP amounted to approximately 4.87%, or more than 6 trillion rubles [22]. These data indicate that the contribution of creative industries to the Russian economy remains relatively small, which may explain the limited investment in this area. The solution to the problem under consideration could be the development of financial instruments for creative industries, such as government grants, subsidies, tax incentives and the creation of funds to support creative start-ups and improve the financial literacy of investors, the development of venture funds that specialize in creative and innovative sectors.

5. Another problem, in our opinion, is the low level of interaction between creative industries and traditional sectors of the economy. The creative economy in the regions often develops in isolation from traditional industries, which hinders the integration of innovative business models that could improve the competitiveness of production and create new products and services. However, the case of Kazan shows that the development of creative industries in combination with traditional industrial sectors such as IT, architecture and design can significantly increase the attractiveness of the region for investors. Therefore, to solve this problem, it is necessary to stimulate interaction between creative and traditional industries through the creation of joint projects and

clusters, as well as through the development of inter-industry research and the introduction of creative solutions into traditional production.

Thus, the development of creative industries in Russian regions faces a number of significant barriers (Table 5), including insufficient government support, lack of infrastructure, shortage of qualified personnel and limited investment. Overcoming these barriers requires a comprehensive approach, including the creation of the necessary infrastructure facilities, support for educational programs and increased investment in the creative economy.

Table 5. Summary of problems hindering the development of regional RPES in the creative economy

Problem	Description
Lack of funding	Less investment in creative projects due to limited budgets at the regional level.
Lack of infrastructure	Underdevelopment of the necessary conditions for the effective operation of creative industries and start-ups.
Low level of education	Lack of educational programs aimed at training specialists in creative fields.
Bureaucracy and regulations	Complex administrative barriers make it difficult to create and develop creative businesses.
Limited sales markets	Difficulty in entering wider markets due to localized needs.
Low support from the authorities	Lack of government support and initiatives to promote creative industries.
Cultural biases	Stereotypes and prejudices towards various forms of creativity hinder development.

Indeed, the development of the creative economy is a multifaceted process that requires a systematic approach and coordination of various initiatives. Despite active efforts to create creative spaces and organize events, there are certain shortcomings that hinder this process.

Firstly, one of the main problems is the lack of a unified strategy for the development of the creative economy at the city or regional level. When initiatives are fragmented and not connected, they lose their effectiveness. The creation of a common strategy that would unite various aspects – from supporting entrepreneurship to developing cultural infrastructure – could help streamline efforts and direct resources to the right areas.

Secondly, more active support from government structures is needed. This may not only be financial support, but also the development of training programs, mentoring, and a network of contacts between creative entrepreneurs and representatives of government institutions. By establishing such a connection, it is possible to solve many problems that creative initiatives face – from bureaucratic barriers to lack of funding.

It is also worth paying attention to the development of infrastructure for creative industries, which includes not only physical spaces (studios, exhibition halls, rehearsal bases), but also digital infrastructure that will help talented people promote their ideas and finished products. In this context, it is important to develop platforms for the distribution of creativity, whether online or locally.

Another aspect worth paying attention to is community engagement and creating an ecosystem around creative projects, as participation local residents, feedback from the target audience and joint work in creating projects can significantly increase interest in creative initiatives and ensure their sustainable development.

3. Significant deficit of institutional and resource support for creative entrepreneurs.

There is a significant deficit in institutional and resource support for creative entrepreneurs, which limits their opportunities for growth and effective functioning. Solving this problem requires a comprehensive approach, including both financial support and the creation of a favorable ecosystem that promotes creativity and innovation.

Firstly, according to the World Bank's Creative Economy Outlook 2022 report, the global creative sector reached US\$2.25 trillion in 2021, highlighting its economic importance [23]. However, in Russia, the sector still faces significant challenges. According to a study conducted by the HSE Creative Economy Lab, only 8% of creative enterprises received funding through government programs in 2020, indicating a clear lack of support [24].

Secondly, according to surveys by the Public Opinion Foundation, less than 15% of Russian creative entrepreneurs said that they are offered adequate funding or mentoring programs. The All-Russian Public Opinion Research Center (VTsIOM) study "Creative Industry: Monitoring" notes that 37% of creative industry representatives face a lack of financial resources, and 28% – a lack of government support. [25]. This is also confirmed by a study by RAEC (Russian Association of Electronic Communications), which notes that 57% of creative startups point to difficulties in accessing funding as the main barrier to growth [26].

An example is the successful case of the creative studio "Easy Art", which focused on the design and production of unique gifts and accessories. Although the studio had high creative ideas and approaches, it faced difficulties in obtaining a loan from banks. Only after working with an independent business accelerator, which offered support in developing a business plan and assistance in entering the market, the studio was able to obtain the necessary funds and reach a new level.

In addition, according to information published on the website of the Government of the Russian Federation, in 2022 the share of creative industries in Russia's GDP was 3.2%, and in 2023 - 3.4% [27]. With regard to the UK and the US, the report "Creative Economy of the SCO Member States" indicates that the contribution of creative industries to the UK economy is 5.5%, and to the US economy - 4.2% [28].

The problem of regulatory barriers remains relevant. For example, according to information from a study by the European Commission, problems with intellectual property protection and the lack of a clear legal framework limit opportunities for innovative creative companies in Russia. More than 60% of survey participants indicated that the need to understand the complexity of legislation makes doing business impossible without the help of lawyers [29].

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